

Quick start

Thank you for your purchase. Here is how to get going in five minutes.

1. OPEN THE FILE

Microsoft Excel (Windows or Mac)

Double-click the .xlsx file. If you see a yellow 'Protected View' or 'Enable Editing' bar, click Enable Editing.

Google Sheets (free)

Go to drive.google.com, click New > File upload and pick the .xlsx file. Then right-click it > Open with > Google Sheets. In Sheets, use File > Save as Google Sheets so you edit a Google copy.

Apple Numbers / LibreOffice

The file opens in both, but it was designed for Excel and Google Sheets, so some colours or charts may look different.

Phone or tablet

Works in the Excel and Google Sheets apps, but a computer is much easier for setting it up.

2. WHAT EACH TAB DOES

Start Here

The same steps as this guide, inside the file.

Dashboard

Income, all expenses, income minus deductible expenses, tax set aside, tax paid and unpaid invoices for the year, plus a monthly chart.

Setup

Tax year, business name, set-aside %, income goal, your clients and expense categories.

Income

One row per payment you receive. 500 rows.

Expenses

One row per business cost. The deductible part fills in from your category. 500 rows.

Invoices

What you billed, when it is due, and whether it is paid. Overdue ones turn red. 200 rows.

Monthly & Tax

Income minus deductible expenses, and your tax set-aside, by month and by quarter. Record the tax payments you make here.

Breakdown

Totals by expense category and by client.

Good to know

- Start a fresh copy of the file for each tax year.
- How set-aside works: it is always your set-aside % of the year so far (income minus deductible expenses), never below zero. A loss month or quarter lowers that figure, so its set-aside shows as a negative amount: money you already put aside that you no longer need to add. The year total always equals your % of the whole year's income minus deductible expenses.
- 'Income minus deductible expenses' is not your final taxable profit. Self-employment tax, allowances and other income are not included.
- An expense with no category, or a category not listed on Setup, counts as 0% deductible until you pick one.
- Cream cells are for typing. White cells calculate, so please leave them alone.
- The quarter dates are the US federal estimated-tax dates. Type your own if you are elsewhere.
- This file helps you save for tax. It does not work out the tax you owe and is not tax advice.

SOMETHING NOT WORKING?

Re-download the original file any time from Etsy: You > Purchases > Download files. Still stuck? Send us a message through Etsy and we will help.